



Figure 3.1 Rational and Irrational Behavior

In [Figure 3.1](#), Wes is situated at a combat checkpoint in Haditha, a village in Al Anbar Province of Iraq. Wes is explaining to his Iraqi counterparts how to set up a tactical checkpoint. A quick inspection of the photograph highlights how a stressful environment can make some people do irrational things. Wes and his Iraqi friend to his right in the photo are wearing their Kevlar helmets, carrying extra ammunition, and have a water source on their gear. The Kevlar is important because mortar rounds are periodically inbound. Rational reaction: Wear Kevlar to prevent hot metal fragments from entering one's head! The ammunition is important because one needs ammunition in a gunfight. Rational reaction: Carry ammo! Finally, water is important, because in 125-degree weather, a lack of hydration can lead to heat stroke. Rational reaction: Carry water! And while all of these things sound rational, the Iraqi on the far right isn't wearing a Kevlar, isn't carrying extra ammo, and doesn't have a source of water.